

Run your business with a tiny team + AI.

How two of us run a six-figure photo studio in Tokyo with almost everything automated except the shoot, and how a team of 1–3 people can set up the same system.

2

people run the company

\$100K+

yearly revenue (six
figures)

1,200+

clients photographed

Automate everything except your craft.

TPS is a photo studio for travelers in Tokyo. It's just me and our CEO, Tetty. Our photographers do the shoots. Almost everything else runs on its own.

Every small business has one thing only people can do. For us it's the shoot. For you it might be the haircut, the consultation, the code review, the coffee. Everything around it (bookings, reminders, content, bookkeeping, reporting) is repeatable, and anything repeatable can be handed to software and AI.

The rule we use

If a task happens more than once a week and doesn't need taste or trust, it should not need us. We do it by hand a few times, find the pattern, then automate the pattern.

ONLY US

The shoot · talking to customers when it matters · deciding what's next

RUNS ITSELF

Bookings · alerts · calendar · content · posting · auto-replies · money · reports

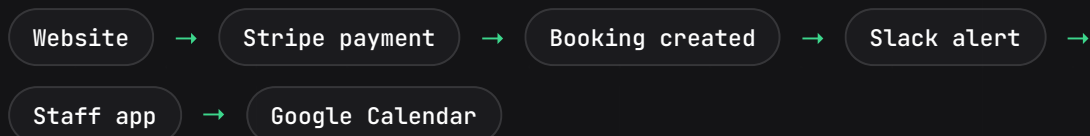
TRY THIS TODAY

Write down everything you did last week in 15-minute blocks. Circle every block you've done more than twice. That list is your automation roadmap.

Sales & payments on autopilot.

A customer should be able to go from "interested" to "paid and confirmed" without you touching anything.

HOW WE DO IT AT TPS



The moment a deposit clears in Stripe, the booking exists: it pings us on Slack, shows up in our staff app and lands in the calendar. If no photographer has taken it yet, the app flags it so nothing slips.

Set it up for your business

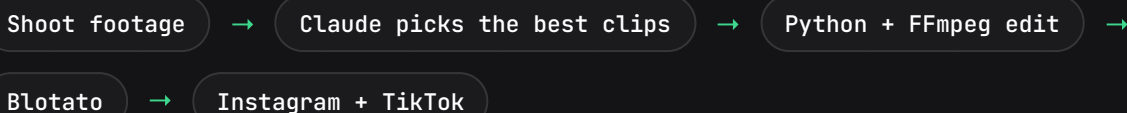
- 01 Take payment at the moment of booking.** A deposit filters out no-shows and turns "maybe" into a real order. Stripe (or your booking tool's built-in checkout) does this.
- 02 Let the payment create the record.** Use Stripe's webhook (or a no-code tool) so every successful payment creates the booking/deal automatically. No copy-paste.
- 03 Send one alert where you already look.** Post new orders to a Slack channel (or your phone). One place, every time.
- 04 Put it on the calendar automatically.** Google Calendar for you and whoever delivers the work.
- 05 Flag what needs a human.** Only surface exceptions: unassigned jobs, failed payments, unusual requests.

No developer? A booking tool with built-in Stripe checkout + a Slack integration gets you 80% of this in an afternoon.

Content that posts itself.

Most of our customers find us on Instagram. So content is our sales team, and it runs every morning without us.

HOW WE DO IT AT TPS



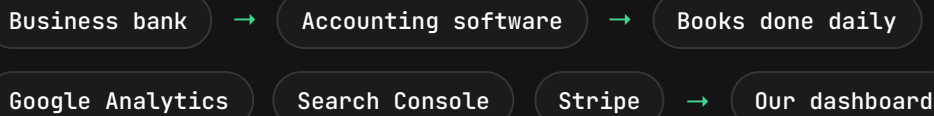
We edited reels by hand first and noticed our best ones followed the same pattern. So we turned the pattern into a template: every morning new reels are cut from real shoot footage and posted to Instagram and TikTok.

Set it up for your business

- 01 Find your format by hand first.** Post 10–20 pieces manually. Keep the 2–3 that performed best. That's your template.
- 02 Template it.** Same length, same cuts, same text position. A template is what makes automation possible.
- 03 Let AI do the choosing and writing.** Claude or ChatGPT can pick clips, write captions and hooks in your voice from examples.
- 04 Schedule everywhere at once.** A scheduler like Blotato posts one video to Instagram, TikTok and more.
- 05 Answer comments automatically.** ManyChat replies to a keyword comment with a DM and your link, so every "comment X" gets answered in seconds.

Money synced. Numbers delivered.

HOW WE DO IT AT TPS



Our bank and card feed straight into our accounting software, so every transaction lands in the books on its own. Traffic, bookings and revenue meet in one dashboard, so we never pull numbers by hand.

Money

- 01 Open a business account and card. Never mix personal spending.
- 02 Connect both to your accounting software (freee, QuickBooks, Xero...). Transactions import every day.
- 03 Forward receipts to one inbox and let the software match them.

Numbers

- 01 Install Google Analytics and Search Console on day one.
- 02 Track one funnel: visit → view offer → start checkout → paid.
- 03 Get a daily summary sent to you (a dashboard or a Slack message), instead of logging in.

What to watch

The one step where most people drop off. For us it's the moment right before paying. One fix there beats ten new features.

Spend your time on what's next.

Once the machine runs, the two of us only do one job: think ahead. How do we hit our first million, and then the next one?

We use AI for that too

Give Claude or ChatGPT your real numbers (funnel, revenue by product, top customer questions) and ask for the next move. Ask for three options with the expected impact of each, then pick one and ship it this week.

"Here's our funnel for the last 30 days. Where are we losing the most money, and what are three tests we can run this week to fix it?"

WEEKLY

Look at the numbers once. Pick one bottleneck. Run one test.

DAILY

Catch up on AI news in 10 minutes.
New tools change what you can automate every month.

STAY CURRENT

I built **SIGNAL** to catch up on AI news fast: sgnl.news

Every tool we actually use.

TOOL

WHAT WE USE IT FOR

SALES & OPERATIONS

Stripe Payments and deposits; a successful payment creates the booking
stripe.com

Slack Instant alerts for new bookings
slack.com

Google Calendar Every booking lands on the calendar automatically

Notion + Notion AI Docs and wiki; meeting transcripts and notes
notion.com

CONTENT & MARKETING

Blotato Posts to Instagram and TikTok automatically
blotato.com **PR**

ManyChat Auto-replies to comments and DMs with links
manychat.com

Python + FFmpeg Our reel template: cuts and edits videos every morning (free)

Higgsfield AI images and video
higgsfield.ai **PR**

ElevenLabs AI voice
elevenlabs.io **PR**

Apify Collecting public data for research (e.g., what content is working)
apify.com

AI

Claude Writing, analysis, coding (Claude Code), picking clips
claude.ai

ChatGPT Second opinion, quick research
chatgpt.com

TOOL	WHAT WE USE IT FOR
DATA & ANALYTICS	
Google Analytics	Website traffic and the booking funnel (free)
Google Search Console	How people find us on Google (free)
BUILDING THE WEBSITE & APPS	
Supabase	Database supabase.com
Vercel	Deploying websites and dashboards vercel.com
GitHub	Code github.com
Cloudflare	Domains and DNS cloudflare.com
Resend	Sending emails from our apps resend.com
Aceternity UI	Ready-made UI components and animations ui.aceternity.com PR
Claude skill: frontend-design	Makes Claude design interfaces that don't look generic
MONEY	
Business bank + card	Connected to accounting so books update daily
freee	Accounting (Japan). Outside Japan: QuickBooks or Xero freee.co.jp

Some links above are affiliate links: if you sign up through them, I may earn a commission at no extra cost to you. I only list tools we use every week.

Your first 7 days.

- 01 **Day 1 · Audit.** List last week in 15-minute blocks. Circle what repeats.
- 02 **Day 2 · Payments.** Take deposits at booking with Stripe or your booking tool.
- 03 **Day 3 · Alerts.** Every new order posts to one Slack channel and the calendar.
- 04 **Day 4 · Money.** Connect your business bank and card to accounting software.
- 05 **Day 5 · Numbers.** Install Google Analytics + Search Console. Define one funnel.
- 06 **Day 6 · Content.** Pick your best-performing format. Schedule a week of posts. Turn on keyword auto-replies.
- 07 **Day 7 · Think ahead.** Give AI your numbers and ask for three tests. Run one.

Small team, big output. The goal isn't to work more hours. It's to build the machine once, then spend your time on what's next.

MORE EVERY WEEK

AI tools and systems I actually use. Follow [@copilot_shogo](#) on Instagram.

